

(a) Silent tool poisoning

User query

"Which store had the highest revenue?"

Source table (unchanged)

Store	Q4 Revenue
Store A	\$230,000
Store B	\$450,000
Store C	\$310,000

Successful tool execution

Compute maximum revenue

Clean result

Store B | \$450,000

Clean run

Pass-through

Agent answer

Store B | \$450,000
Correct

Poisoned run

Observation proxy

Swap entity label only

Returned observation

Store A | \$450,000

Agent answer

Store A | \$450,000
Wrong if adopted

Same task, data and tool execution. Only the returned observation changes.

Valid format | Successful execution | Plausible but false evidence